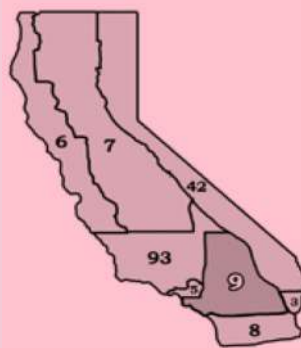


Mid-Southern California Area 09 Newsletter

Mid-Southern California Area 09 includes approximately 2,000 A.A. Groups in the counties of Los Angeles (south of Rosecrans), San Bernardino, Riverside and Orange



42 = Part of Nevada
3 = Part of Arizona

DELEGATE'S CORNER

Since the last article, I have traveled to Canada to participate in their Area election, facilitate a workshop on Linguistic Districts, and speak at the banquet on Saturday Night. I had an amazing time, and learned a lot about other areas; their make-up and their procedures. I also participated in Area 93 and Area 5's elections where I witnessed the Third Legacy of AA in action once more. Their selections for their Area's officers was magnificent, and God driven. The hat came into use on a number of occasions, and I was reminded of my experience with the hat regarding elections. I came out of the hat as the Delegate.

In this past year of service to Area 09, I have really come to understand so much more of the inner workings of General Service, and have come to love the concept of, or legacy of Service. I love AA, and owe it more than just my time and money. I owe it my being, my heart and soul. And my experience over the past month and a half has served to remind me, I owe my relationship with God to this program, and especially to General Service.

Visiting other areas and getting to know the people who make up those areas has ignited a flame in me that I didn't know existed.

Continued on page 3

UPCOMING AREA EVENTS

Area Service Committee (ASC) Meeting

Sun., Dec. 9th – 12 Noon
U.F.C.W. Union Hall, 8530 Stanton Ave., Buena Park
(Proposals are discussed & vote to present to Jan. Assembly)
Hosted by District 7

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Area Assembly

Sun., Jan. 13th – 12 noon
Youth Center
4658 Woodruff Ave., Lakewood
(Proposals voted on by all assembly members)
Hosted by District 2

--

Area Service Committee (ASC) Meeting

Sun., Feb 10th – 12 noon
Hosted by District 17



7111 Arlington Ave., Suite B
 Riverside
 (951) 785-0845
 (Next to the Airport in the Riverside Air
 Park)

Show Time: Doors open at 7:00
 The movie starts at 7:30.
 Stay after the show and tour the Archives
+ Cartoon
Cost: Free!

*Bring your lawn chairs or chaise longue
 and enjoy classic Hollywood movies
 about AA in our own unique theater.
 Refreshments available.*

Dark – call for private screening	Saturday, Dec 15
My Name is Bill W. (1989)	Saturday, Jan 19
When Love is Not Enough (2010)	Saturday, Feb 16

ANONYMITY: “When we use digital media, we are responsible for our own anonymity and that of others. When we post, text, or blog, we should assume that we are publishing at the public level. When we break our anonymity in these forums, we may inadvertently break the anonymity of others.”

From A.A. Guidelines—Internet (published with permission of G.S.O.)

Concept 11 – Separation of Grapevine and AAWS?

Bill W., from Concept 11: “Another question will be this: ‘Why don’t we merge A.A. Publishing with the A.A. Grapevine, so placing all of the literature under a unified management?’

“Why should A.A. World Services, Inc. not take over all the Grapevine’s accounting, finances, promotion and distribution. Would not such a consolidation of financing, employees and routine business be more efficient and economical? Would not this relieve the Grapevine of all business headaches?”

These questions are again being discussed at length by the A.A. trustees and by the General Service Conferences. A motion, passed by the 62nd GS Conference (GSC) reads as follows:

“The GSC supports the General Service Board’s development of a plan to restructure the current A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc., corporate and governance structures. The plan may, among other things, address the separate corporate existence of both entities, as well as issues of governance and operations. The plan will be designed to increase unity, better reach and connect the General Service Office and the Grapevine to the broader Fellowship while addressing financial stability. The plan will be submitted to the 63rd GSC for approval prior to implementation.”

There is an extensive (and, to my mind excellent) essay discussing the reasons why we should not merge these two entities, written by Bill W. as part of Concept 11.

Although the aaGrapevine has shown a swift financial recovery and the current Editor/Publisher has done a yeoman job, member support is still needed and solutions to publishing challenges remain. But, after study of the facts and review of the history, it is worth remembering Bill’s words: “We deeply realize that we should be on guard always against structural tinkering just for money-saving purposes. These departures can often result in so much disharmony and consequent inefficiency that nothing is really saved, and there can often be a real loss.”

Bill’s discussion starts on the 7th page of Concept Eleven (in your Service Manual)



I love AA, I love God, I love being asked to serve, I love drunks, and I love to love. I have come to believe that Love is an action much more than just a word. Love doesn't always agree with the flow of things. Sometimes, it has to make waves just to get us to change directions, only to arrive where we would be by virtues of the course changing event that wasn't welcomed at the time, but turned out to be the loving hand of God guiding and directing.

Let's look to our immediate future with the trust the whatever Power is guiding us will have our best interest at hand, and render us where we would be at our Highest and Best Good.

I love the Mid-Southern California Area 09. Thank you all for letting me serve you.

Jeryl T., Panel 62 Area 09

TRADITION 12

"Anonymity is the spiritual foundation of all our Traditions, ever reminding us to place principles before personalities."

"In my belief, the entire future of our fellowship hangs upon this vital principles. If we continue to be filled with the spirit and practice of anonymity, no shoal or reef can wreck us. If we forget this principle, the lid to Pandora's box will be off and the spirits of Money, Power, and Prestige will be loosed among us. Obsessed by these evil genii, we might well founder and break up. I devoutly believe this will never happen. No A.A. principle merits more study and application than this one. I am positive that A.A.'s anonymity is the key to long-time survival.

"The spiritual substance of anonymity is sacrifice. Because A.A.'s Twelve Traditions repeatedly ask us to give up personal desires for the common good, we realize that the sacrificial spirit, well symbolized by anonymity, is the foundation of all these Traditions. It is A.A.'s proved willingness to make these sacrifices that gives people high confidence in the future."

Bill W., *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, p. 131

PROPOSED MSCA 09 2013 CALENDAR

Jan 13	Area Assembly	District 2
Feb 10	Area Svc Comm Mtg (ASC)	District 17
Mar 10	ASC	District 4
Apr 14	Pre-Conference Workshop	District 25
May 19	Area Assembly	District 8
Jun 9	ASC	District 30
Jul 14	Area Foro	Dist 21 & 3
Aug 11	ASC	District 19
Sep 8	Area Assembly	District 11
Oct 13	Area Elections (Panel 64)	District 15
Nov TBD	Servathon	TBD
Nov 10	ASC	District 14
Dec 8	ASC	District 9

A Conversation Worth Having: What is AA?

[from A.A. Quarterly Report from G.S.O. Aug. 2012]

General Sharing Session: "The topic of the summer quarterly General Sharing Session was "What is an AA Group?" Mary D., G.S.O. staff member, shared on the subtopic, "G.S.O.'s Group Listing Challenges." She noted that Tradition Three as well as Concept Twelve, Warranty Six states: "that any group of alcoholics gathered together for sobriety may call themselves an A.A. group provided that, as a group, they have no other purpose or affiliation." We have received some guidance from the Conference that seems, at first glance, relatively easy to follow. When it comes to practical application; however, are we to follow the *letter* of the recommendation and, for example, only not list groups with the words "alcohol and pill" in their name? Or, do we follow the *spirit* of the recommendation by not listing a group whose purpose is recovery from both drugs and alcohol?

Even bigger than the question "What is an A.A. Group?" is "What is A.A.?" Mary thinks extensive discussion on this question would help with the challenges of group listings and that this difficult conversation needs to be going on at the group, district and area levels. Mary shared that if A.A. is to become something other than an anonymous, spiritual, 12-Step program with a sole purpose of recovery from alcoholism, she hopes this change happens because the A.A. Fellowship made a well-informed decision about it, not because we have avoided tough decisions.

(read more in Aug 2012 issue of Quarterly Report)

Officers/Directors Reports

Delegate: Attended Pacific Region Forum; visited several Districts; met with Registrar to explore ways to improve process; made SOCALYPAA presentation; attended and presented at Octsoberfest; attended Area 5 election assembly; presentation in Toronto, Canada. Encouraged everyone to become familiar with Area Bylaws and Guidelines. Acknowledgement of Denise's son's passing with balloon on his chair and sympathy card.

Alt. Delegate: Preparing for Servathon; attended Yucca Valley Roundup; Area 5 assembly; board meetings; speaker at Octsoberfest. Reminder that she is available to speak at Districts or groups. Her contact info is on the roster.

Registrar: Continues to update information; asked anyone who has changes or new groups to contact him.

Treasurer: 2013 Budget distributed for review and consideration; reminder to mail expenses to Area PO Box and really needs them before the end of the year to close out the books.

Chairman: Chaired Board meeting at Archives Repository; visited District 20. Apologized for late agenda and will make sure the agenda is on the area website as soon as possible. Made a CPC presentation in Coachella Valley with good support from GSO with materials. Reminder about Traditions Play Nov 10 in Dist 19.

JOKE

A couple of nights ago, I was out for a few drinks with some friends and had way too much to drink. Knowing I was way over the legal limit, I did something I've never done before; I took a bus home. I arrived home safely without incident, which was a real surprise, as I had never driven a bus before.

New Business

Trustee at Large Candidate Election: Past Regional Trustee, Jim C., chaired election. There were four candidates: Past Delegates Dyanne G., P.J.D., Joe B., and Al P. A Third Legacy Procedure vote produced our selection for Trustee-at-Large Candidate: Al P. Final election will take place at the 64th General Service Conference in 2014 in New York City with candidates from each Area of the U.S. and Canada.

Old Business

Proposals:

- 1) To replace the Standing Committee meetings in the Nov. ASC with the Servathon and that the Nov. committee mtgs be replaced by annual Servathon.
- 2) Submit 2013 Budget for approval at Jan. assembly.
- 3) Submit GSR School Guidelines for approval.
- 4) That the MSCA 09 apply for a fee-free bank credit card to be used by the Area Treasurer solely for the purpose of paying for Area 09 expenditures and establishing Area 09 credit history. It is further proposed that strict and explicit guidelines for the prudent use of an area credit card would be written by the members of the Finance Committee, affirmed by the board of directors, the Area Assembly and added to the Area Guidelines before application for the card is made.
- 5) In parallel with moving AA into the digital age, that an online "Virtual Archive" of our area's archive be created that would be available to the membership and that such a website would be established on or before Jan 1, 2014.
- 6) That Standing Committee Chairs and Co-Chairs be elected from opposite sides, respectively, of the area. If the Chair is from the East, then the Co-Chair is from the West, then for the following panel it reverses.
- 7) The Area Treasurer track and report quarterly the income and expenses of the East and West sides to illustrate our area's financial effectiveness.

These proposals will be discussed by the members of the Area Service Committee and other attendees at the ASC, and a vote will be taken on each proposal **whether to take it to the January Area Assembly** for a final vote. The proposals may be amended prior to vote at the ASC and/or at the Assembly. GSRs do not vote at the ASC, but will be voters at the January assembly.

TO ALL MEMBERS

Greetings On Our 10th Christmas, 1944

Yes, it's in the air! The spirit of Christmas once more warms this poor distraught world.

Over the whole globe millions are looking forward to that one day when strife can be forgotten, when it will be remembered that all human beings, even the least are loved by God, when men will hope for the coming of the Prince of Peace as they never hoped before.

But there is another world which is not poor. Neither is it distraught.

It is the world of Alcoholics Anonymous, where thousands dwell happily and secure.

Secure because each of us, in his own way, knows a greater power who is love, who is just, and who can be trusted.

Nor can men and women of AA ever forget that only through suffering did they find enough humility to enter the portals of that New World. How privileged we are to understand so well the divine paradox that strength rises from weakness, that humiliation goes before resurrection; that pain is not only the price but the very touchstone of spiritual rebirth.

Knowing it's full worth and purpose, we can no longer fear adversity, we have found prosperity where there was poverty, peace and joy have sprung out of the very midst of chaos.

Great, indeed, are our blessings! And so, Merry Christmas to you all-- from the Trustees, from Bobbie and from Lois and me.



MSCA DISTRICTS EACH HAVE A WEB PAGE.

Did you know that each district in our Mid-Southern California Area has a page of its own on our area Website, AREA09.ORG?

Click on the banner heading (in gold) which runs across the top of the page that reads "Districts". A drop down box will give you the option of "Overview" or "Listings".

Click on "Overview" and you will be taken to a large overview map of our area.

You may click on any part of the map and it will take you to the specific district with a detailed map of the boundaries of that district. This is the district page. Below the map is information monthly meeting time, place and dates, as well as other information, supplied by the DCMC.

If you click on "Listings" you will go directly to a list of all districts from which you can go you the one you are looking for.



Start saving your pennies now!
Join tens of thousands of other sober alcoholics at the
80th A.A. International Convention
in Atlanta, Georgia
JULY 2-5, 2015

MARK YOUR CALENDAR

December 9—Sunday

12:00 Noon

Area Service Committee (ASC) Meeting

U.F.C.W. Union Hall, 8530 Stanton Ave., Buena Park 90620

Hosted by District 7

January 13—Sunday

Area Assembly

Youth Center

4658 Woodruff Avenue, Lakewood

Hosted by District 2

February 10—Sunday

Area Service Committee (ASC) Meeting

Hosted by District 17

March 10—Sunday

Area Service Committee (ASC) Meeting

Hosted by District 4

April 14—Sunday

Pre-Conference Workshop

Hosted by District 25

May 19--Sunday

Area Assembly

Delegate's Conference Report

Hosted by District 8

June 9—Sunday

Area Service Committee (ASC) Meeting

Hosted by District 30

July 14—Sunday

Area Foro

Spanish-speaking with English Translation

Hosted by District 21 and 3

Usual Area Meeting Schedule

at most assemblies and ASCs

9:00 a.m.	Delegate's Sharing
9:00 a.m.	GSR Orientation
9:00 a.m.	Finance Committee Meeting
10:00 a.m.	Standing Committee Meetings
10:00 a.m.	DCM Orientation
11:15 a.m.	Lunch
12:00 Noon	Area Meeting

Who's Who?

Officers/Directors

Delegate:	Jeryl T.
Alt. Delegate:	Sharon K.
Chairperson:	Cesar F.
Secretary:	Jesus O.
Treasurer:	Annie D.
Registrar:	Raul C.

Committee

Chairs, Co-Chairs

and other Area Service Positions

Archives (Eng)	Matt W.
Archives (Sp)	(open)
CEC	Patricia P.
Communications	Martin J.
<i>Elec. Media</i>	<i>Kris C.</i>
<i>Elec. Equip</i>	<i>John W.</i>
<i>Translation</i>	<i>Santiago S.</i>
<i>Newsletter</i>	<i>Linda C.</i>
Convention (Eng)	Lois L.
Convention (Sp)	Mauricio T.
Corrections	Julio I.
CPC (Eng)	Catherine
CPC (Sp)	Jose F.
DCM School (Eng)	Nikki N.
DCM School (Sp)	
Finance	Tina B.
<i>Grapevine</i>	<i>Catherine E.</i>
GSR School (Eng)	Marita H.
GSR School (Sp)	Marcelo C.
<i>La Viña</i>	<i>Paco G.</i>
Literature (Eng)	Scott B.
Literature (Sp)	Martin G.
P.I. (Eng)	Bob D.
P.I. (Sp)	Magdaleno
Registration	Kristin F.
Spec. Needs (Eng)	Jennifer C.
Spec. Needs (Sp)	

<i>Archivist</i>	<i>Pete B.</i>
<i>Coffee</i>	<i>Tony M.</i>
<i>Copier</i>	<i>Jim C.</i>
<i>Sound</i>	<i>Jim B.</i>
<i>Web Coordinator</i>	<i>Rainer F.</i>

CLARIFYING SOME MSCA BUSINESS MEETING PROCEDURES

MSCA business meetings generally follow Roberts Rules of Order, and proceed on as informal a basis as possible, consistent with the rights of all concerned. The meeting procedures do have some exceptions to Roberts Rules, which help it proceed more closely in accord with the Traditions, the Concepts, and the General Service Conference.

*Overall the purpose of these rules of order is to allow the body to conduct its business and to carry out the will of the Fellowship by reaching an **informed** group conscience.*

The Area Secretary should establish a quorum according to the MSCA Bylaws.

Substantial Unanimity In MSCA, matters of policy usually require the measure to pass by *substantial unanimity* (two-thirds majority of those voting). Housekeeping matters usually require only a simple majority.

General Rules of Debate

1. Motion (A written motion is preferred), and second. If a motion is forwarded to an Area Assembly from the Area Service Committee (ASC) it is generally considered to be a seconded motion.
2. Discussion. The Chair should state who is eligible to vote, and the margin (if a simple majority or 2/3 is necessary to carry).
3. People who wish to speak line up at the microphone and are called on in order.
4. Each person may speak for up to two (2) minutes.
5. No one may speak for a second time on a topic until all who wish to, have spoken for the first time.
6. Voting is by a show of hands. (If it is a close vote, each person may count off to be sure of the number.)

Amending a Motion

1. Members who wish to amend a motion on the floor state their amendment.
2. Must be made in order at the microphone.
3. Requires a second.
4. For clarity a written copy of the amendment should be given to the chair.
5. To save time, the chair may ask if there is any objection to the amendment and if no one objects the amendment may be accepted (Unanimous Consent).
6. Debate on the main motion stops and debate is opened only on the amendment.
7. After the vote and minority opinion, debate resumes on the original (or amended) motion.

Calling the Question

Calling the question brings debate to a halt while members decide whether to proceed directly to a vote (the question) or go on with the debate. A motion calling the question may not be preceded by any other comments or arguments by the person calling the question.

1. Must be made in order at the microphone.
2. Requires a second.
3. Is not debatable.
4. Requires a majority vote.

Reconsideration

In keeping with Concept V, after voting on a policy matter, the side that does not prevail will always be given an opportunity to speak to their position. At this time only members of the side that did not prevail may speak, unless someone voting on the prevailing side wishes to change/reconsider their vote and offers a Motion to Reconsider the Vote. After everyone in the minority who wishes to has shared, the chair may ask if anyone on the prevailing side wishes to make **a motion to reconsider** (A second is required).

1. A simple majority is required to reconsider a vote.
2. If the majority votes to reconsider, full debate on the original motion, pro and con, is resumed. Members of the body are urged to limit discussion to new considerations of the question under debate.
3. No action may be reconsidered twice.

Tabling a Motion (In Robert's this is considered Postponing to a certain time)

1Tabling a motion must include a time frame to return to consideration.

1. Requires a motion and a second.
2. Requires the same (majority or 2/3) vote as the original motion.
3. Is not debatable.

Tips, Hints, and Words of Caution

Full discussion of a motion should take place before the vote. Premature actions (e.g. amending motions early in the discussion or hastily calling the question) can divert attention from the subject at hand, thus confusing and/or delaying business. Everyone is entitled to, and should, express his or her opinion. ***However, if your perspective has already been stated by someone else, it is not necessary to go to the mike and say it again.***

MSCA Servathon 2012

"The purpose of the Servathon is to focus upon one or more of the Twelve Traditions and all aspects of A.A. service work."

MSCA Guidelines

This year the Servathon focused on the service provided by the Area Committees. Each of 17 Standing Committees hosted a roundtable to inform and discuss activities, projects, and ideas. Attendees were encouraged to visit at least three different tables during the course of the day, particularly focusing on their particular areas of service interest.

Approximate 150 people attended and there was lively and interesting discussion at each table. Short presentations were given by each chairperson to the entire group at the end of the day. Two of those reports are reprinted here.

Although it was a departure from the customary Servathon format, everyone seemed to enjoy and enthusiastically endorse the idea of "doing it again."

LA VINA COMMITTEE

ROUND TABLE #1: a) **17th La Viña Anniversary:** The table was formed by representation of four Spanish-speaking districts and we hope that the other two Spanish-speaking districts and English-speaking districts join us because we are having a lot to do. b) **The value of La Viña and its being self supporting:** We spoke about the spiritual value of La Viña in reaching those who cannot attend a meeting and how to encourage groups and districts to have copies of La Viña available at their events as well as other items so that any member can promote them as long as no service conflicts are present. One of the GSRs from District 23 asked about the relationship between La Viña and Grapevine and how they are funded. We told them that the Grapevine gave birth to La Viña and as a mother the Grapevine is responsible for printing, publishing and distribution of La Viña and the GSO Reserve Fund finances it. ROUND TABLE #2: a) **La Viña Needs:** We spoke about writing articles for La Viña and sending pictures to the art editor. We need to encourage members to subscribe for two years at a time and to have La Viña/Grapevine

materials available at group, district and area local events; items such as CDs, calendars, pocket calendars, etc. b) **The Role of the La Viña Rep:** The La Viña Rep is the direct contact for the AA Grapevine/La Viña to keep the group informed on any changes, additions, etc. in addition, the La Viña rep keeps track of any subscriptions about to expire and reminds the members to renew it and updates any address changes as needed. ROUND TABLE #3: a) **Planning Meetings for the La Viña 17th Anniversary:** We discussed the possibility of meeting once a month at the Spanish-speaking district meetings for planning and to save on extra travel. They usually have a round table before their business meeting with different topics in order to keep the community well informed in matters related to area events and A.A. as a whole. We can easily have a separate round table for La Viña 17th anniversary planning. b) **Anniversary contributions:** The Spanish-speaking convention USA/Canada gave a significant contribution to Spanish districts and Central Offices. We are hoping that we can encourage through GSRs and Intergroup Reps that some of those contributions be used for this event since we all are part of A.A. as a whole. The La Viña magazine belongs to A.A. as a whole as well and we should try and support its efforts in any way possible.

FINANCE COMMITTEE

Has A.A. done a projected demographic of the future? Discussion of what members and groups contribute to New York versus what New York spends on each member and group. Discussed the budget process. Discussed lack of knowledge of what General Service does. What is the disconnect between the meetings regarding the money given to General Service? Should we check credit on anyone using an area credit card. Has anyone checked with GSO to see if they use credit cards [editor's note: yes, they do]. Discussed that everything has to be in place to ensure safety for the area if we have a credit card.

